

The Very Best Products Of 2008

It's that time of the year again. December; the one time we do not conduct any comparison tests. This is the time to contemplate; on the year that has gone. It's *Zero1 Awards* time. This is the time we reward the best products of the year in each category with a much coveted *Zero1 Award*. Since we already give awards to our comparison test winners, one might question the need for another reward. The fact is that our reward system as selective and thorough as it is; is far from perfect. Allow us to explain. We test a particular product category a few times a year — at the most. However, manufacturers refresh product lines several times a year. In fact it's a common occurrence for us to just finish with a test based on a product category, only to find a slew of new products releasing a few weeks later.

Digit's Zero1 Award is one of India's most coveted trophies; find out which products walk away as the true champions of 2008

For us *Zero1* represents the pinnacle of our testing endeavours; and the podium belongs only to the best. This is one award we take doubly seriously; with utmost commitment to quality. And the reason behind this is you — our devoted readers; who deserve the very best of our efforts. As a labour of love and our devotion to our reader, in addition to our challenge to remain the very best when it comes to providing informed product reviews, we undertake

the daunting task of conducting a thorough market survey. We study each of the product categories that are covered under the *Zero1* umbrella. We compare the best products, as per our reviews, in each category to any new products that were not in market at the time of our comparison test, and try to ascertain for ourselves if the newcomer has a chance of besting the reigning champion. We consider features, performance and price here.

If we feel a new product stands a good chance of displacing the winner, we call for the product for review. Once in our test labs, we submit it to the same gamut of tests that we use in our comparison test. The answer as they say; is in the scores, and if the results are positive, we have a new winner; and thus a *Zero1 Award* winner is born. In case the products we tested remain the best available to date, then they're rewarded with a shiny trophy of their own. Our awards ceremony (to be announced soon) is the time when a trophy is actually presented to the manufacturer. This is our way of saluting the best product available for the current year. The manufacturer gets a shiny accolade to decorate his mantle, our readers are informed about the best products; and we have the distinct pleasure of knowing that our sleepless nights have benefitted somebody.

